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EXECUTIVE PITCH BRIEF

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# NextPatient

Staff Software Engineer: Legacy Integration & Platform Architecture (Ruby/Rails)

**Target Role:** Staff Software Engineer: Legacy Integration & Platform Architecture (Ruby/Rails)

**Company:** NextPatient

**Comp Range:** \$250,000: \$300,000 / yr (Remote, Full-time)

**Tone Calibration:** Understated, fact-dense, zero-fluff. Written for engineering leadership & technical screeners.

## 1. Mission & Architectural Alignment

NextPatient's mandate: **decoupling modern patient experiences (scheduling, check-in, waitlists, payments) from dated, legacy doctor's office EHR systems:** is a direct match for my 25+ year track record in **System Cartography**, **legacy subsystem decoupling**, and **zero-downtime platform safety**.

### Why This Match Works (3 Grounded Signals):

1. **High-Consequence System Integration & Uptime Protection:** Extensive background in 4D System Cartography and operational risk modeling, mapping dark dependencies, lateral state mutations, and establishing release verification gates across deployment pipelines to protect mission-critical uptime.
2. **Strangler-Fig Decoupling & API Boundary Design:** At OneMain Financial, refactored high-volume financial customer acquisition flows spanning legacy database layers, multi-service Rails state machines, and third-party API supply chains: eliminating hidden lateral state mutations and cross-service blind spots.

3. **OpenTelemetry & Dark Telemetry Illumination:** Founded and technically led the enterprise OpenTelemetry initiative at OneMain, converting dark legacy microservice behavior into empirical telemetry and quantifiable risk governance.

## 2. Fit Matrix & Seniority Calibration

| Dimension          | NextPatient Expectation                                                         | Mike’s Grounded Evidence                                                                                         | Fit Evaluation             |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Legacy Integration | Plug modern SaaS into legacy EHRs without breaking live clinical operations.    | Strangler-fig API decoupling across financial monoliths; zero-downtime data migrations.                          | 🟢 Direct Match             |
| Backend & Stack    | Heavy Ruby on Rails, PostgreSQL, background jobs, zero-downtime migrations.     | 25+ years Ruby/Rails, PostgreSQL (including pgvector), Sidekiq/Redis, AWS/Kubernetes.                            | 🟢 Core Stack Match         |
| Platform Ownership | Staff IC leadership, responsibility realignment, developer velocity enablement. | Founded and technically led ACQ Enablement team at OneMain; led cross-team architecture reviews.                 | 🟢 Staff/Principal IC Match |
| Culture & Alumni   | High technical autonomy, async documentation, craftsmanship rigor.              | Groupon alumnus; founded Software Craftsmanship McHenry County (820+ members); author of <i>Panoramic View</i> . | 🟢 Cultural Parity          |

## 3. Proven Case Studies for NextPatient Leadership

1. **OneMain Financial Acquisition Lane Realignment (2021 to 2026):**
- *Challenge:* Implicit lateral state mutations across multi-step Rails state machines caused persistent data corruptions in high-volume loan acquisition flows.
  - *Action:* Refactored workflow state transitions, mapped seven acquisition channels, engineered an automated 5-phase PII deletion engine across 30+ tables, founded ACQ Enablement, and deployed enterprise OpenTelemetry tracing across microservice boundaries.
  - *Outcome:* Diagnosed and eliminated a persistent 4% silent traffic drop at e-signing, unblocked engineering streams, and built the Enterprise Trace.

- *Reference:* [case-studies/index.html#onemain-acquisition](https://just3ws.com/case-studies/index.html#onemain-acquisition)

## 2. SK Holdings & Real Estate Platform Modernization:

- *Challenge:* Monolithic Rails application experiencing search bottlenecks and Sidekiq background queue congestion under high transaction volume.
- *Action:* Upgraded core Rails versions with zero downtime, restructured relational database indexes, and modernized asynchronous worker queues.
- *Outcome:* Restored application throughput and reduced queue latency across search and transaction pipelines.
- *Reference:* [history/index.html#sk-holdings](https://just3ws.com/history/index.html#sk-holdings)

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## 4. 30-Second Interview Calibration (The “Answer, Frame, and Pause” Rule)

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*“I specialize in strangler-fig modernization: connecting modern user interfaces and SaaS platforms to fragile legacy backends without disrupting live production operations. At OneMain Financial, I led the Acquisition architecture, mapping seven ingress channels, eliminating a 4% silent traffic drop at e-signing with OpenTelemetry, and safely purging legacy PII across 30+ tables. NextPatient faces the classic challenge of modernizing clinical patient workflows against legacy EHR systems, and my background is built specifically to de-risk those integrations.”*

*(Pause & Hook): “I can dive deeper into how we decoupled multi-step Rails workflows, or we can look at how we safely migrated legacy database records. Which direction would you prefer to explore?”*

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## 5. Authoritative Verification Links

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- **System Cartography Essay:** [just3ws.com/2026/08/29/system-cartography-how-to-map-a-ten-year-old-monolith/](https://just3ws.com/2026/08/29/system-cartography-how-to-map-a-ten-year-old-monolith/)
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